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DATA MODERNIZATION AND ANALYTICS GOVERNANCE

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This instruction implements Air Force Policy Directive (AFPD) 90-70, *Enterprise Data Management*. It establishes Air Force Global Strike Command (AFGSC) guidance for data modernization and analytics activities across AFGSC, and aligns with Department of Defense Instruction (DoDI) 8320.02, *Sharing Data, Information, and Information Technology (IT) Services in the Department of Defense*, DoDI 8320.07, *Implementing the Sharing of Data, Information, and Information Technology (IT) Services in the Department of Defense*, Department of the Air Force Instruction (DAFI) 90-7001, *Enterprise Data Sharing & Data Stewardship*, and Air Force Doctrine Note 25-1, *Artificial Intelligence*. This publication applies to AFGSC Regular Air Force, military and civilian personnel as well as Air Force Reserve Command (AFRC) and Air National Guard (ANG) units aligned under AFGSC. It does not apply to the United States Space Force. . This publication may be supplemented at any level, but all supplements must be routed to the OPR of this publication for coordination prior to certification and approval. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the office of primary responsibility using Department of the Air Force (DAF) Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Product*. Ensure all records created as a result of processes prescribed in this publication are maintained in accordance with Air Force Instruction (AFI) 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and disposed of in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule located in the Air Force Records Information Management System. The authorities to waive wing, and unit level requirements in this publication are identified with a tier number ("T-0, or T-3") following the compliance statement. See Department of the Air Force Manual (DAFMAN) 90-161, Publishing Processes and Procedures, for a description of the authorities associated with the Tier numbers. Submit requests for waivers through the chain of command to the appropriate tier waiver approval authority, utilizing guidance identified in DAFMAN 90-161.

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Chapter 1

GENERAL

1.1. Purpose. This instruction establishes AFGSC policy, roles, and procedures for governing data modernization and analytics (DM&A) activities, to include artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning (ML)-enabled capabilities, across the Command. It provides a framework to ensure DM&A efforts are aligned to Commander (CC) priorities, coordinated across AFGSC organizations, and executed in a manner that maximizes decision advantage while minimizing duplication and inefficiency. This instruction operationalizes the following strategies for AFGSC: the 2026 *Artificial Intelligence Strategy for the Department of War*, the 2020 *DoD Data Strategy*; the 2023 *Department of Defense Data, Analytics, and Artificial Intelligence Adoption Strategy*; the *2026 Department of the Air Force Data Strategy*; and the 2026 *Department of the Air Force Artificial Intelligence Strategy*.

1.2. Background. To maintain decision advantage in an era of strategic competition, AFGSC must move with purpose and speed. DAF Data and AI Strategies direct a fundamental shift away from legacy processes toward a culture of aggressive acceleration and calculated risk-taking. Historically, siloed data and analytics efforts created friction, slowed innovation, and hindered the integration of mission-critical capabilities. This instruction directly counters that legacy by establishing a governance framework reimagined as a tool to accelerate capability, not inhibit it.

1.2.1. In alignment with the DAF Data and AI Strategies, this instruction establishes an agile, tiered governance model designed to dismantle bureaucratic barriers and empower innovators. Its primary purpose is to drive the rapid and continuous deployment of data-driven tools and AI-powered capabilities into the hands of our warfighters. The model achieves this by pushing decision-making and collaboration to the lowest appropriate level, ensuring that governance enables execution at the speed of relevance.

1.2.2. This framework is not another layer of bureaucracy; it is a mechanism for disciplined speed. It provides just enough structure to connect innovators with the resources, data, and authorities they need to succeed, while aggressively deconflicting efforts to maximize the impact of our limited analytic and development capacity. This instruction formalizes that streamlined construct and its associated processes to accelerate the Command's transformation into a data-centric, AI-enabled force.

1.3. Definitions and Scope.

1.3.1. The following definitions establish the scope of activities governed by this instruction.

1.3.2. Data Modernization. The deliberate transformation of legacy, siloed information environments into an interoperable, cloud-centric, and AI-ready data architecture. Data modernization is the foundational engineering required to treat data as a strategic enterprise asset.

1.3.2.1. Activities include data engineering, the creation of automated data pipelines, Application Programming Interface (API) development, data cataloging/exposure, cloud data migration, and the structuring of unstructured data to enable machine learning.

1.3.2.2. Activities do not include routine IT infrastructure recapitalization (e.g., buying new laptops, upgrading base fiber optics), standard software patching, or the sustainment

of legacy systems that are not actively being integrated into the enterprise data fabric. It also does not include restructuring unit-level shared drives (e.g., SharePoint, Teams), creating local databases for internal unit tracking, or writing automation scripts that do not alter the Command's enterprise architecture.

1.3.3. Data Analytics (and AI/ML). The operational exploitation of enterprise data to drive decision advantage at the speed of relevance. This represents the entire spectrum of transforming raw data into actionable insight, from descriptive reporting to autonomous machine decision-making. This includes qualitative and quantitative analyses and assessments.

1.3.3.1. Activities include the development and deployment of automated dashboards, business intelligence tools, predictive mathematical models, ML algorithms, Generative AI, and any software application whose primary function is to aggregate and analyze data to inform Commander or warfighter decisions.

1.3.3.2. Activities do not include routine staff work, manual spreadsheet tracking, localized unit-level dashboards (defined as a product created for internal use and is not built on an enterprise-level platform), ad-hoc analytical products, or the use of standard office productivity software for basic record-keeping. Analytics intended for a single unit or directorate are also not included.

1.3.4. Enterprise-level Platform. A large-scale, authoritative data environment engineered to ingest, integrate, and federate disparate datasets from multiple distinct databases and source systems. Enterprise-level platforms are designed to break down data silos, provide cross-domain visibility, and serve as the foundational architecture for advanced analytics, AI, and Command-wide decision advantage.

1.3.4.1. Examples of enterprise-level platforms include, but are not limited to, Vault, Envision, MAVEN, and Blade.

1.3.4.2. This definition explicitly excludes decentralized, tactical, or localized applications used primarily for team-level workflow management, basic data visualization, or isolated data storage. Software applications and builds on database platforms or custom-coded tools intended for the exclusive use of a single unit, squadron, or directorate are not classified as enterprise-level platforms.

1.3.5. Data Modernization and Analytics Governance (DMAG) Thresholds. The DMAG is designed to accelerate enterprise-level capability, not to micromanage daily staff operations or local data management. Subordinate units and directorates are fully empowered to execute localized DM&A efforts without DMAG oversight. A data modernization effort, analytical product, study, or automated tool must be submitted to the DM&A portfolio (reference **Chapter 4**) only if it meets one or more of the following enterprise thresholds.

1.3.5.1. Cross-Organizational Impact. The effort analyzes data spanning multiple directorates/subordinate units, its final product is intended to drive change across multiple units, or it involves exposing a unit's previously siloed data to the enterprise federated catalog.

1.3.5.2. Outputs and Platforms. A project that creates a persistent digital tool (e.g., dashboard, application, ML model) on an enterprise-level platform.

1.3.5.3. Architecture and Integration. The effort requires establishing new, automated connections to authoritative data sources, developing new APIs, or altering Command data schemas.

Chapter 2

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

2.1. AFGSC Commander (CC).

2.1.1. The AFGSC/CC provides strategic direction and serves as the senior decision authority for Command DM&A efforts. The AFGSC/CC:

2.1.2. Establishes Command priorities that guide DM&A investments and focus areas.

2.1.3. Chairs the Data Modernization and Analytics Council (DMAC).

2.1.4. Makes final decisions on enterprise tradeoffs, reprioritization, and direction of DM&A activities when elevated.

2.1.5. Ensures DM&A efforts support mission execution, strategic priorities, and decision advantage.

2.2. AFGSC Chief of Staff (CoS).

2.2.1. The AFGSC/CoS synchronizes Headquarters (HQ) AFGSC staff activities in support of the AFGSC/CC's decision cycle. The AFGSC/CoS will:

2.2.2. Oversee day-to-day staff execution related to DM&A processes.

2.2.3. Ensure staff alignment with AFGSC/CC-directed DM&A priorities.

2.2.4. Facilitate coordination across directorates to accelerate enterprise integration.

2.3. AFGSC/Chief Data and Artificial Intelligence Officer (CDAO).

2.3.1. The AFGSC/CDAO provides Command leadership for data and analytics as strategic assets. The AFGSC/CDAO will:

2.3.2. Oversee execution of the Command data, analytics, and AI strategy.

2.3.3. Serve as the Chair for the Data Modernization and Analytics Board (DMAB).

2.3.4. Advise the AFGSC/CC, DMAC, and DMAB on data and AI adoption.

2.3.5. Ensure alignment with Department of War (DoW) and DAF data and AI initiatives.

2.3.6. Coordinate with the AFGSC Chief Information Officer (CIO) to ensure data priorities are supported by secure, sustainable IT architectures.

2.3.7. Coordinate with the AFGSC Chief Analytics Officer (CAO) to ensure analytic rigor, methodological soundness, and delivery considerations are appropriately integrated into Command-level governance and decision-making.

2.4. AFGSC Chief Information Officer (CIO).

2.4.1. The AFGSC/CIO provides oversight and guidance for IT, cybersecurity, and digital infrastructure supporting DM&A efforts. The AFGSC/CIO will:

2.4.2. Ensure DM&A initiatives align with Command IT, cyber, and network architectures.

2.4.3. Serve as the Deputy Chair for the DMAB.

2.4.4. Provide guidance on cybersecurity, system authorization, and interoperability requirements.

2.4.5. Ensure sustainable and secure digital enablement of DM&A capabilities.

2.5. AFGSC Chief Analytics Officer (CAO).

2.5.1. The AFGSC/CAO provides senior advisory leadership for analytic rigor, methodology, and delivery across AFGSC. The AFGSC/CAO will:

2.5.2. Serve as the principal advisor for analytic rigor, methods, and technical quality.

2.5.3. Advise governance bodies on analytic feasibility, sequencing, and delivery risk.

2.5.4. Promote standardization of the analytic process and leverage previous analytic products.

2.5.5. Enable integration of analytic best practices across HQ AFGSC organizations.

2.6. HQ AFGSC Directorates and Special Staff.

2.6.1. HQ AFGSC directorates and special staff offices will:

2.6.2. Participate in working group and DMAB collaboration and coordination as required.

2.6.3. Provide early identification of duplication and integration dependencies.

2.6.4. Leverage existing data architectures and existing analytic products, when feasible.

2.6.5. Register DM&A efforts, including organic, contractor-executed and hybrid initiatives, and relevant external activities for portfolio visibility (see **Chapter 4** for exclusions).

2.6.6. Execute approved DM&A efforts in accordance with assigned roles and responsibilities.

2.7. Numbered Air Forces (NAFs) and Wings.

2.7.1. NAFs and Wings play a critical role in identifying, shaping, and executing DM&A activities that support operational readiness, mission execution, and local decision-making. NAFs and Wings will:

2.7.2. Identify operational, functional, and readiness-related analytic needs.

2.7.3. Submit DM&A requests and portfolio visibility registrations as appropriate.

2.7.4. Execute local DM&A efforts within delegated authorities and available capacity.

2.7.5. Participate in working group and DMAB collaboration and coordination when efforts affect enterprise integration or cross-organizational alignment.

2.7.6. Leverage enterprise analytic products, tools, and capabilities when available to reduce duplication and accelerate delivery.

Chapter 3

DATA MODERNIZATION AND ANALYTICS GOVERNANCE

3.1. Governance Overview and Principles.

3.1.1. AFGSC will employ an agile, tiered DM&A governance model built to prioritize speed and accelerate capability delivery. This model uses deliberate coordination and clear decision authorities to remove barriers and ensure timely execution. This model also ensures DM&A needs are addressed at the lowest appropriate level, integrated across the enterprise where required, and elevated to senior leadership only when decisions or tradeoffs are necessary. The governance model intentionally separates working-level collaboration, enterprise integration, and AFGSC/CC-level decision authority to reduce duplication, preserve limited analytic and development capacity, and prevent unnecessary approval gates. Governance bodies are designed to enable execution, not delay it. This model applies equally to traditional DM&A activities as well as AI- and ML-enabled capabilities.

3.1.2. This governance construct is designed to enable, not constrain, DM&A activities at the NAF and Wing levels. The framework provides visibility, coordination, and access to enterprise capabilities while preserving local initiative, responsiveness, and speed in support of operational readiness and mission execution.

3.1.3. Calculated Risk Posture. In accordance with DAF Data and AI Strategies, AFGSC accepts that the strategic risk of delayed capability deployment outweighs the tactical risk of imperfect alignment. Governance bodies at all tiers will employ a 'calculated risk-taking' posture, actively promoting iterative, imperfect solutions (minimum viable products (MVPs)) to ensure warfighters receive data and AI capabilities at the speed of relevance.

3.2. Governance Flow.

3.2.1. DM&A activities progress through a sequential and collaborative governance flow:

3.2.1.1. Analytic demand enters through standardized intake mechanisms.

3.2.1.2. The Data Analytics and Integration Working Group (DAI-WG) and Data Governance and Architecture Working Group (DGA-WG) operate at the working level to frame problems, explore solution options, and address feasibility, governance, and architectural considerations. The DAI-WG focuses on analytic design, problem framing, and AI-enabled solution development, while the DGA-WG addresses data governance, architecture alignment, access, and technical sustainability considerations.

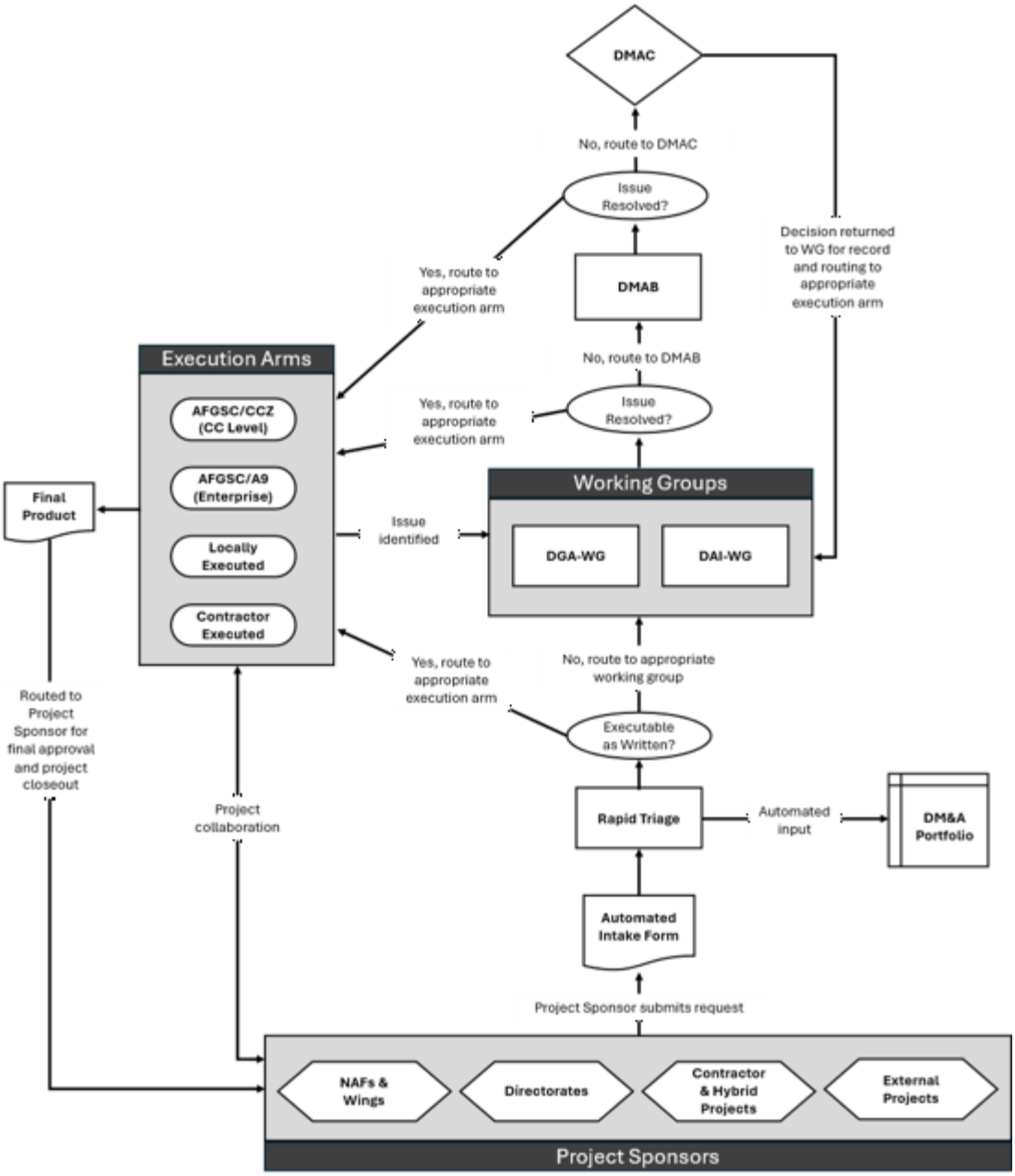
3.2.1.3. The DMAB validates and prioritizes Command data and analytic requirements, promotes enterprise awareness, mitigates duplication, and prepares issues for senior decision when required.

3.2.1.4. The DMAC, chaired by the AFGSC/CC, provides strategic direction and final decision authority when required.

3.2.2. **Figure 3.1** illustrates the sequential and collaborative flow of DM&A activities across AFGSC. DM&A activities are first identified, prioritized, and assigned during the intake process (see **Chapter 5**), and execution is performed by designated organic, contractor-executed, or hybrid teams (see **Chapter 6**). DM&A problem-framing, coordination,

deconfliction, issues, and risks are addressed at the working level by the DAI-WG and DGA-WG. Issues requiring enterprise integration or deconfliction are elevated to the DMAB. Matters requiring AFGSC/CC decision or direction are elevated to the DMAC. NAFs and Wings engage the DM&A governance construct primarily through demand signaling, working-level collaboration, and execution of locally scoped efforts. This construct is intended to enable field activities through visibility and coordination, not to centralize execution.

Figure 3.1. DM&A Process Flow.



3.2.3. Risk Acceptance Authority. Not all efforts require elevation beyond the working level. Many initiatives are resolved through collaboration and coordination without requiring enterprise integration or senior decision. The DMAB is explicitly authorized to encourage

calculated operational, programmatic, and integration risks to accelerate the deployment of pilots and MVPs. The DMAB shall prioritize iterative fielding over delayed perfection. Risk decisions will be elevated to the DMAC when a project presents a severe, unmitigated threat to enterprise architecture, cybersecurity, or mission-essential functions.

3.2.4. Technical Risk for Prototyping. To foster innovation and rapid experimentation, the DAI-WG and DGA-WG are empowered to accept localized technical and architectural risks for development environments, prototypes, and limited-scale pilots. Standard enterprise compliance checks shall be tailored or deferred to avoid inhibiting early-stage capability discovery, provided base-level cybersecurity constraints are met.

3.3. Data Analytics and Integration Working Group (DAI-WG).

3.3.1. Purpose and Role. The DAI-WG is the primary working-level forum for collaboration, coordination, and solution shaping for DM&A efforts. It enables clarity of intent, analytic rigor, and effective coordination by translating operational, functional, and leadership questions into well-defined analytic problems and feasible solution approaches. It is intentionally designed to be collaborative and fast-moving and does not function as a gatekeeper, approval body, or prioritization authority.

3.3.2. Membership.

3.3.2.1. The DAI-WG is chaired by the AFGSC/CAO or their designated representative.

3.3.2.2. The DAI-WG will include representatives from HQ AFGSC directorates and offices with formal data, analytics, assessment, operational analysis, or decision-support responsibilities.

3.3.2.3. Membership may include representatives from NAFs and Wings when analytic efforts affect field operations, readiness, or mission execution. Participation is situational and purpose-driven and does not require permanent field representation.

3.3.2.4. Membership is flexible and mission-driven and may include other analysts, data scientists, subject-matter experts, technical practitioners, and external entities appropriate to the analytic need.

3.3.3. Responsibilities. The DAI-WG may:

3.3.3.1. Translate operational, staff, and leadership questions into clearly framed analytic or decision problems.

3.3.3.2. Clarify decision context, scope, and intended use of analytic outputs.

3.3.3.3. Explore analytic approaches, methods, tools, and data sources.

3.3.3.4. Identify feasibility considerations, dependencies, and constraints.

3.3.3.5. Highlight opportunities for reuse or alignment with existing analytic efforts.

3.3.3.6. Identify cross-functional dependencies and coordination requirements.

3.3.3.7. Provide integration of operational, functional, and technical perspectives.

3.3.3.8. Highlight potential data, skill set, or capacity constraints.

3.3.3.9. Identify when enterprise execution, local execution, or contractor support may be appropriate.

3.3.3.10. Document recurring analytical and skill set gaps for visibility and leadership awareness.

3.3.3.11. Flag issues requiring data governance or architecture coordination for referral to the DGA-WG.

3.3.3.12. Resolve routine coordination issues at the working level to the maximum extent possible.

3.3.4. Processes. DAI-WG processes include collaborative problem framing sessions, solution exploration discussions, working-level deconfliction and integration, and preparation of context and options for elevation to the DMAB when enterprise integration or coordination is required. The DAI-WG will accelerate problem framing by delivering initial analytic approaches and feasibility assessments within five (5) business days after the working group convenes.

3.3.5. Analytic Acceleration. The DAI-WG will operate as an accelerator for mission owners. When reviewing proposed use cases, the DAI-WG will prioritize connecting requestors with existing analytical work, platform environments, and analytical talent. The DAI-WG will focus on deconflicting redundant efforts to free up capacity, not on restricting the development of novel analytic approaches.

3.3.6. Outputs. Typical DAI-WG outputs may include:

3.3.6.1. Clearly framed analytic problem statements.

3.3.6.2. Defined decision context and intended analytic use.

3.3.6.3. Recommended analytic approaches or methods.

3.3.6.4. Identified coordination, feasibility, or capacity considerations.

3.3.6.5. Referrals to the DGA-WG for governance or architecture coordination.

3.3.6.6. Inputs to support enterprise integration discussions.

3.4. Data Governance and Architecture Working Group (DGA-WG).

3.4.1. Purpose and Role. The DGA-WG serves as the working-level forum for coordinating data governance, architecture, access, and technical alignment considerations associated with DM&A efforts. The DGA-WG enables sustainable, secure, and interoperable execution by identifying governance requirements, architectural dependencies, and technical risks early in the DM&A lifecycle.

3.4.2. Membership.

3.4.2.1. The DGA-WG is Chaired by the AFGSC/CIO or their designated representative.

3.4.2.2. The DGA-WG will include representatives from HQ AFGSC directorates and offices with responsibilities related to data stewardship, architecture, integration, cybersecurity, system authorization, and technical enablement.

3.4.2.3. Membership may include representatives from NAFs and Wings when data governance and architecture efforts affect field operations, readiness, or mission execution. Participation is situational and purpose-driven and does not require permanent field representation.

3.4.2.4. Membership is flexible and tailored based on the technical nature of issues under consideration.

3.4.3. Responsibilities. The DGA-WG may:

3.4.3.1. Address data ownership, stewardship, and accountability considerations.

3.4.3.2. Clarify data access, sharing, and use constraints.

3.4.3.3. Review alignment with existing data, system, and enterprise architectures.

3.4.3.4. Identify technical risks, constraints, or dependencies that may affect delivery timelines or solution viability.

3.4.3.5. Identify opportunities to reuse existing data sources, platforms, or architectures.

3.4.3.6. Coordinate with cybersecurity, authorization, and infrastructure stakeholders as appropriate.

3.4.3.7. Flag risks related to security, access, system limitations, or downstream sustainment.

3.4.3.8. Support alignment with DAF and DoW data governance policies.

3.4.3.9. Document considerations to inform execution planning and leadership awareness.

3.4.4. Processes. DGA-WG processes are designed to be enablers, not gatekeepers. They include accelerated governance and standards coordination with the goal of providing actionable architectural guidance within five (5) business days after the working group convenes. Matters that exceed working-level resolution are elevated to the DMAB with documented considerations and risks.

3.4.5. Enabling Architecture Integration. The DGA-WG should actively dismantle technical barriers for innovators. Rather than passively auditing projects for compliance, the DGA-WG shall develop and distribute pre-approved architectural patterns, integration templates, and automated compliance tools. The primary responsibility of the DGA-WG is to assist developers in rapidly connecting to authoritative data sources and fielding capabilities without navigating bureaucratic friction.

3.4.6. Outputs. Typical DGA-WG outputs may include:

3.4.6.1. Documented governance considerations and data access requirements.

3.4.6.2. Identified architectural dependencies or integration risks.

3.4.6.3. Technical feasibility observations.

3.4.6.4. Recommendations to leverage existing platforms or standards.

3.4.6.5. Inputs to support enterprise coordination or leadership awareness.

3.5. Data Modernization and Analytics Board (DMAB).

3.5.1. Purpose and Role. The DMAB serves as the Command's primary validation, prioritization, and integration authority for enterprise DM&A activities. The DMAB actively dismantles bureaucratic barriers, deconflicts redundant efforts, and drives the rapid deployment of data modernization and analytic capabilities. It functions as the critical link between working-level innovation and senior-level resourcing, translating enterprise visibility

into actionable decisions to ensure validated priorities are rapidly executed and scaled across AFGSC.

3.5.2. Membership.

3.5.2.1. The DMAB is chaired by the AFGSC/CDAO or designated representative.

3.5.2.2. The AFGSC/CIO serves as the Deputy Chair to ensure alignment with information technology, cybersecurity, and architectural considerations.

3.5.2.3. The AFGSC/CAO is a standing member and principal advisor for analytic rigor and delivery considerations.

3.5.2.4. The AFGSC Chief Technology Officer (CTO) serves as an advisory member and provides perspective on enterprise technology direction, modernization trajectories, emerging capabilities, and technical debt considerations. The AFGSC/CTO advises the DMAB on alignment between proposed DM&A efforts and the Command's broader technology evolution.

3.5.2.5. The AFGSC Chief Architect (CA) serves as an advisory member and provides perspective on enterprise architecture coherence, interoperability, integration dependencies, and long-term sustainability. The AFGSC/CA advises the DMAB on architectural alignment and integration risk across DM&A efforts.

3.5.2.6. Primary membership also includes:

3.5.2.6.1. DAI-WG and DGA-WG representatives to provide DM&A context and integration insight.

3.5.2.6.2. Subject matter experts (SMEs) from HQ AFGSC directorates and functional areas with formal DM&A responsibilities.

3.5.2.7. Membership will include representatives from NAFs and Wings when enterprise integration or cross-organizational alignment affects relevant field operations, readiness, or mission execution. Commanders will ensure appropriate personnel are selected for membership based on DM&A initiative. However, participation is situational and purpose-driven and does not require permanent field representation.

3.5.2.8. Additional membership is flexible and may include other analysts, data scientists, subject-matter experts, technical practitioners, and external entities as appropriate.

3.5.3. Resource Adjudication and Enforcement. The DMAB is the Command's designated validation and prioritization authority for enterprise data requirements. To maintain execution velocity, subordinate units and staff directorates may not unilaterally halt or passively veto a DMAB-validated capability by withholding funding or personnel. In the event of a legitimate resource constraint or conflict that threatens a validated priority, the DMAB will escalate the issue to the DMAC. Final de-confliction, resource realignment, and decision authority rests exclusively with the AFGSC Commander.

3.5.4. Risk Acceptance for Rapid Fielding. The DMAB is explicitly authorized to accept calculated operational, programmatic, and integration risks to accelerate the deployment of pilots and MVPs. The DMAB shall prioritize iterative fielding over delayed perfection.

3.5.5. Responsibilities. The DMAB will:

3.5.5.1. Provide enterprise visibility and portfolio awareness.

3.5.5.1.1. Maintain enterprise-level awareness of ongoing, planned, and in-queue DM&A efforts.

3.5.5.1.2. Maintain visibility of organically executed, contractor-executed, and external efforts relevant to AFGSC.

3.5.5.1.3. Promote transparency across HQ directorates, NAFs, Wings, and execution arms.

3.5.5.2. Facilitate integration and deconfliction of DM&A activities.

3.5.5.2.1. Identify actual or potential duplication of analytic or development efforts.

3.5.5.2.2. Highlight conflicting scopes, timelines, or dependencies.

3.5.5.2.3. Facilitate alignment across execution arms and organizations.

3.5.5.2.4. Support consolidation or sequencing discussions when appropriate.

3.5.5.3. Maintain capacity awareness and assess tradeoff risk.

3.5.5.3.1. Maintain awareness of enterprise-managed execution capacity posture.

3.5.5.3.2. Monitor capacity strain across Commander-facing, enterprise, and local execution lanes.

3.5.5.3.3. Identify sustained overload, displacement effects, or delivery risk.

3.5.5.3.4. Highlight potential tradeoffs that may require leadership awareness or decision.

3.5.5.4. Approve, prioritize, and initiate phased execution for Command-wide DM&A pilots, MVPs, and other capability scaling.

3.5.5.5. Prepare issue framing and decision briefs.

3.5.5.5.1. Integrate and deconflict inputs from the DAI-WG and DGA-WG to provide enterprise-view of DM&A efforts.

3.5.5.5.2. Frame issues with clear context, impacts, risks, and options.

3.5.5.5.3. Prepare decision-ready issues, options, and tradeoffs for elevation to the DMAC.

3.5.6. Processes. DMAB processes include portfolio awareness reviews, enterprise deconfliction discussions, integration of working group inputs, review and approval of Command-wide DM&A initiatives, resource adjudication and preparation of issues requiring AFGSC/CC decision or direction. To expedite DM&A activities, the DMAB will review, approve, and/or decide to escalate issues to the DMAC within five (5) business days after the board convenes.

3.5.7. Outputs. Typical DMAB outputs may include:

3.5.7.1. Enterprise visibility summaries of DM&A activities.

3.5.7.2. Identification of duplication, conflict, or integration risk.

3.5.7.3. Capacity posture awareness and emerging tradeoffs.

3.5.7.4. Integrated issue framing for potential escalation.

3.5.7.5. Recommendations for coordination or sequencing adjustments.

3.5.7.6. Approval of Command-level initiatives.

3.5.7.7. Adjudication of resources.

3.6. Data Modernization and Analytics Council (DMAC).

3.6.1. Purpose and Role. The DMAC serves as the senior decision authority for DM&A governance. The DMAC addresses issues that require AFGSC/CC direction, prioritization, or resolution of enterprise tradeoffs.

3.6.2. Membership. The DMAC is chaired by the AFGSC/CC. Membership consists of senior AFGSC leadership as designated by the AFGSC/CC and includes representation from NAFs, Wings, and key functional and staff organizations as appropriate.

3.6.3. Responsibilities. The DMAC may:

3.6.3.1. Establish Command-wide priorities and strategic direction for DM&A efforts.

3.6.3.2. Resolve DM&A enterprise tradeoffs that exceed working-level or board-level coordination authority.

3.6.3.3. Direct reprioritization or strategic adjustments when required to support mission execution.

3.6.4. Processes. DMAC processes include review of issues elevated by the DMAB, adjudication of tradeoffs, and issuance of AFGSC/CC-level decisions and guidance. Routine coordination and execution matters are expected to be addressed at lower levels of the governance structure.

3.7. Execution and Review.

3.7.1. 'Path to Yes' Guidance. Governance bodies within the DMAG act as capability enablers, not compliance gatekeepers. If a proposed DM&A effort or AI capability is deemed misaligned with current standards, governance bodies are prohibited from issuing a flat rejection. Instead, reviewing bodies must proactively provide a documented 'Path to Yes,' detailing the specific, minimum viable adjustments or waivers required for the effort to proceed.

3.7.2. Sole Rejection Authority. To prevent bureaucratic friction from stifling innovation, subordinate governance bodies (including the DAI-WG, DGA-WG, and DMAB) do not possess the authority to terminate or outright reject a proposed Command-wide DM&A effort. If a governance body cannot establish a viable 'Path to Yes,' or if the unmitigated risks of an effort exceed their delegated risk acceptance authority, they may not cancel the project. Instead, the effort must be elevated to the DMAC. Only the AFGSC Commander (or the designated DMAC Chair) retains the authority to formally reject a Command-wide DM&A proposal. All such escalations must be accompanied by a clear articulation of the barriers and the specific risks that prevented lower-level approval.

3.7.3. Minimum Viable Product (MVP). AFGSC discourages long-lead, legacy 'waterfall' development lifecycles for DM&A and AI capabilities. All Command-sponsored DM&A efforts should adopt an Agile execution framework.

3.7.3.1. MVP Timelines and Execution. Project sponsors and execution teams will target an aggressive 90-to-120 day MVP delivery cycle, commencing from the date of official project kick-off. The objective is to rapidly field an 80% solution to gather real-world operational feedback, rather than delaying deployment in pursuit of a 100% perfect solution.

3.7.3.2. Dependency Management and Escalation. Projects encountering critical external dependencies (e.g., enterprise data connections, vendor support tickets, lack of stakeholder engagement, or datasets requiring new links to enterprise-level platforms) that will delay the MVP release beyond the 120-day limit will not simply pause development indefinitely. Instead, these issues must be immediately brought to the respective working group (DAI-WG or DGA-WG) for discussion, barrier mitigation, and an approved path forward. Coordination and resolution of technical dependencies will be handled at the lowest level possible, but unresolved bottlenecks will be reported to the DMAB to ensure command-level visibility and resource prioritization.

3.8. Performance Measurement and Effectiveness.

3.8.1. The DMAB, in coordination with the DAI-WG, DGA-WG, and execution arms, should develop and track standardized Measures of Effectiveness (MOEs) and Measures of Performance (MOPs) to evaluate the operational impact and efficiency of all data initiatives.

3.8.2. The DMAB shall implement routine self-assessment mechanisms to measure its own governance effectiveness. The Board should explicitly identify strategic gaps, execution bottlenecks, or process inefficiencies for internal resolution, or escalate them to the DMAC when authoritative intervention is required.

Chapter 4

DATA MODERNIZATION AND ANALYTICS (DM&A) PORTFOLIO

4.1. Purpose. The intent of the DM&A Portfolio is to provide enterprise-level visibility of DM&A activities to mitigate duplication, enable coordination, and support informed decision-making. Portfolio visibility ensures leadership and governance bodies maintain awareness of ongoing, planned, and in-queue efforts across HQ AFGSC. Portfolio visibility supports NAFs and Wings by reducing duplication of effort, increasing awareness of existing analytic products and tools, and enabling access to enterprise capabilities that may be reused or adapted to meet local operational needs. Visibility is intended to enhance support to the field, not to replace or override locally executed DM&A activities.

4.2. DM&A Portfolio Visibility.

4.2.1. All HQ AFGSC DM&A efforts, whether organically executed, contractor-executed, or hybrid, will be registered through the standard intake mechanism for portfolio visibility. This requirement applies regardless of funding source, execution organization, or perceived scope of effort.

4.2.2. Portfolio visibility is a governance and coordination mechanism. It does not create approval authority, alter existing roles, or interfere with execution timelines.

4.2.3. Portfolio registration is designed to be lightweight and non-intrusive. Registration:

4.2.3.1. Does not imply approval, endorsement, or prioritization.

4.2.3.2. Does not delay execution of authorized or in-scope work.

4.2.3.3. Does not modify contract scope, funding authority, or acquisition decisions.

4.2.3.4. Does not constitute acquisition oversight or program management.

4.2.3.5. Does not include daily operational analytics and assessments used by units or offices for the purposes related to their respective mission sets or areas of responsibility.

4.2.4. Registration captures limited, non-proprietary information necessary to understand the nature, purpose, and scope of DM&A efforts. This information supports duplication mitigation, reuse identification, and enterprise awareness without imposing additional burden on executing organizations.

4.2.5. The DM&A Portfolio is located on the Envision Platform.

4.3. Contractor-Executed and Hybrid DM&A Efforts.

4.3.1. Contractor-executed DM&A efforts are activities that are managed and overseen solely by an AFGSC-contracted organization, whereas hybrid DM&A efforts are those activities that are managed and overseen by AFGSC but are executed with contract support. Contractor-executed and hybrid DM&A efforts can present unique visibility and coordination risks when managed independently across directorates. To mitigate these risks, government sponsors are responsible for registering contractor-supported efforts through the standard intake mechanism.

4.3.2. Registration of contractor-executed efforts supports awareness of externally delivered analytic and development capabilities, reduces risk of duplicative or overlapping contractor

work across directorates, enables identification of opportunities for reuse or alignment, and promotes responsible stewardship of limited fiscal resources.

4.3.3. Registration information will be limited to non-proprietary, contracting-safe data elements and will not interfere with contract execution, performance management, or contracting officer authority.

4.4. External DM&A Activities.

4.4.1. In addition to internal and contractor-executed efforts, AFGSC will maintain portfolio awareness of select DM&A activities that provide potential benefit to Command decision-making, analytic capability, or future integration opportunities. External activities may include, but are not limited to, efforts conducted by Federally Funded Research and Development Centers (FFRDCs), University Affiliated Research Centers (UARCs), DoW research organizations, or other government-sponsored analytic entities.

4.4.2. Inclusion of external DM&A activities in the AFGSC portfolio is intended solely to support awareness, coordination, and informed engagement. Portfolio awareness of external activities does not imply Command sponsorship, tasking authority, funding responsibility, endorsement, or execution oversight and does not modify existing research, contracting, or governance authorities.

4.4.3. External DM&A activities may be registered in the portfolio when they:

4.4.3.1. Address problem sets, missions, or decision areas relevant to AFGSC.

4.4.3.2. Present potential opportunities for analytic reuse, transition, or integration.

4.4.3.3. Inform future data, analytics, or AI adoption considerations.

4.4.3.4. Provide insight into emerging methods, tools, or technologies of interest to the Command.

4.4.4. Portfolio entries for external activities will be limited to non-proprietary, publicly releasable, or government-approved information and will not interfere with ongoing research execution or contractual arrangements.

4.4.5. Responsibility for External Portfolio Entries.

4.4.5.1. Responsibility for maintaining awareness of external DM&A activities within the portfolio is assigned by functional domain to ensure appropriate subject-matter oversight:

4.4.5.1.1. The AFGSC/CDAO or designated representative is responsible for identifying and maintaining portfolio awareness of external AI and ML activities, including research, experimentation, and capability development efforts that may inform responsible AI adoption, transition opportunities, or future Command initiatives.

4.4.5.1.2. The AFGSC/CIO or designated representative is responsible for identifying and maintaining portfolio awareness of external activities related to data architecture, data platforms, interoperability frameworks, infrastructure, and technical integration considerations relevant to AFGSC systems and environments.

4.4.5.1.3. The AFGSC/CAO or designated representative is responsible for identifying and maintaining portfolio awareness of external analytic, assessment, and decision-

support activities, including studies, models, methodologies, and analytic frameworks relevant to AFGSC missions and priorities.

4.4.5.2. These responsibilities support enterprise awareness and coordination and do not confer authority to direct, modify, or prioritize external research or analytic activities.

4.5. Data Access and Federated Catalogs.

4.5.1. In accordance with Deputy Secretary of Defense memorandum, *Creating Data Advantage*, AFGSC treats data as a strategic enterprise asset. "Data hoarding" or artificially restricting access to mission data by functional silos is explicitly prohibited. To drive data-centric warfare and ensure seamless integration with DAF and the DoW Chief Data and Artificial Intelligence Officer, the following apply:.

4.5.1.1. Federated Cataloging. All AFGSC system owners, program managers, and functional data stewards should establish, continuously maintain, and update federated data catalogs. These catalogs must expose system interfaces (e.g., APIs), data assets, and access mechanisms across all classification levels to the maximum extent possible.

4.5.1.2. Exposure and Visibility. System owners must ensure their data catalogs are continuously visible and integrated into the Command's centralized data architecture to the maximum extent possible. The DMAB shall identify and eliminate any bureaucratic, technical, or cultural barriers preventing the automated exposure of these catalogs to the enterprise.

4.5.1.3. Compliance and Upward Integration. To meet DoW requirements for rapid data advantage, all internal AFGSC data catalogs shall be structured to immediately synchronize with DAF and DoW-level federated catalogs. The DGA-WG will provide the required architectural templates to ensure this integration occurs seamlessly and without administrative delay.

4.5.2. While AFGSC pursues enterprise data visibility, the Command must balance rapid data advantage with legal, ethical, and regulatory obligations to safeguard sensitive information.

4.5.2.1. All AFGSC data modernization, cataloging, and federation activities must comply strictly with the Privacy Act of 1974, the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1996 (HIPAA), and DoW privacy regulations. The unauthorized exposure, deanonymization, or compromise of Airmen's Personally Identifiable Information (PII) or Protected Health Information (PHI) is strictly prohibited.

4.5.2.2. The DMAB and DGA-WG shall mandate and implement technical safeguards prior to any enterprise exposure. System owners and program managers must utilize data masking, stripping, or obfuscation to de-identify PII and PHI at the source. Where the exposure of raw PII/PHI is explicitly required to meet a validated mission requirement, system owners must enforce strict, audited Role-Based Access Controls (RBAC) to ensure these data assets are only accessible to authorized users with a verified "need-to-know."

Chapter 5

PRIORITIZATION AND CAPACITY MANAGEMENT

5.1. Overview. This chapter establishes the integrated processes through which AFGSC receives, evaluates, sequences, and allocates resources to DM&A efforts. Intake, triage, prioritization, and capacity management are treated as a single, continuous workflow designed to balance responsiveness to AFGSC/CC priorities with disciplined stewardship of limited analytic and development capacity. Together, these processes ensure DM&A demand is clearly understood, aligned to strategic intent, assessed for feasibility and duplication, and sequenced appropriately across available execution resources. This integrated approach enables timely delivery of decision-relevant products while preserving agility, transparency, and enterprise coordination.

5.2. Intake Process.

5.2.1. AFGSC will employ a standardized intake process to ensure visibility, consistency, and strategic alignment of DM&A requests and ongoing efforts. All requests for analytic products, assessments, dashboards, tools, or related decision-support activities, as well as existing efforts requiring portfolio visibility, are submitted through the AFGSC Data Modernization, Analytics, Assessments, and Dashboards (DMAAD) Intake Form.

5.2.2. AFGSC DMAAD Intake Form. The AFGSC DMAAD Intake Form will serve as the primary mechanism for capturing essential, non-proprietary information necessary to understand the decision context, strategic relevance, anticipated outcomes, data considerations, execution constraints, and potential workforce capability or training gaps associated with each effort. The intake mechanism is designed to be accessible and lightweight, enabling timely submission without creating unnecessary administrative burden.

5.2.2.1. The AFGSC DMAAD Intake Form is located on the Envision platform and may be updated as needed to support evolving governance requirements. AFGSC/A9 is responsible for updating, maintaining, and sustaining the AFGSC DMAAD Intake Form.

5.2.2.2. Submission of an intake form does not imply approval, prioritization, or commitment of resources. The intake process serves as the formal entry point for portfolio visibility, rapid triage, and coordination, and does not alter contracting authority, funding decisions, or execution responsibility.

5.3. Rapid Triage.

5.3.1. Purpose. Rapid triage is the initial, time-bound evaluation of DM&A requests conducted to clarify intent, assess feasibility, and determine appropriate routing without delaying execution. Rapid triage is designed to be lightweight and expeditious and does not constitute detailed analysis, approval, or prioritization.

5.3.2. Responsibility.

5.3.2.1. Rapid triage is conducted at the working level by a designated triage function led by AFGSC/A9 for DM&A intake management. The triage function coordinates as needed with SME representatives to ensure timely and informed assessment.

5.3.2.2. As appropriate, rapid triage may incorporate advisory input from:

5.3.2.2.1. The AFGSC/CDAO for data strategy alignment or AI- or ML-related considerations.

5.3.2.2.2. The AFGSC/CIO for data access, architecture, or technical enablement considerations.

5.3.2.2.3. The AFGSC/CAO for analytic clarity, methods, or feasibility considerations.

5.3.2.3. Rapid triage does not require standing boards, formal meetings, or consensus decision-making.

5.3.3. Scope. Rapid triage is intended to identify how a request should proceed, not whether it should be executed. Rapid triage will use the information provided in the AFGSC DMAAD Intake Form to assess:

5.3.3.1. Clarity of the decision question or analytic problem.

5.3.3.2. Alignment with AFGSC/CC priorities and Command strategic objectives.

5.3.3.3. Type of effort requested (e.g., assessment, analytic study, dashboard, tool, or AI-enabled capability).

5.3.3.4. Feasibility based on data availability, technical considerations, and capacity constraints.

5.3.3.5. Potential overlap with existing, planned, or external efforts.

5.3.3.6. Whether enterprise coordination or integration may be required.

5.3.4. Outcomes.

5.3.4.1. Rapid triage will result in one or more of the following outcomes:

5.3.4.1.1. Assignment to a priority tier to inform sequencing and capacity planning.

5.3.4.1.2. Identification of the appropriate execution lane or OPR (see **Chapter 6** for more details).

5.3.4.1.3. Routing to a working group for problem framing, solution shaping, or technical coordination.

5.3.4.1.4. Alignment with an existing or in-progress effort to enable reuse or consolidation.

5.3.4.1.5. Redirection or refinement of requests determined to be out of scope or infeasible as currently written.

5.3.4.1.6. Closure of requests determined to be executed, being executed, or input for the purpose of situational awareness.

5.3.4.2. Rapid triage outcomes will be documented to support transparency, continuity, and enterprise awareness.

5.3.4.3. Those who input the request will receive notification of the triage outcome.

5.3.5. Working Group Routing.

5.3.5.1. Requests are routed to working groups when additional collaboration, clarification, or coordination is required prior to execution.

5.3.5.1.1. Requests are routed to the DAI-WG when problem framing, analytic approach development, cross-functional coordination, or assessment design is required.

5.3.5.1.2. Requests are routed to the DGA-WG when data access, governance, architecture alignment, interoperability, cybersecurity, or technical feasibility considerations must be addressed.

5.3.5.2. Routing to a working group does not constitute approval, prioritization, or execution tasking. Working group engagement is intended to resolve issues at the lowest appropriate level and improve the quality and feasibility of subsequent execution.

5.3.6. Timeliness. To ensure a bias for action, rapid triage will be completed within five (5) business days of a requestor's submission. This timeline serves as a forcing function to prevent administrative delay and accelerate the delivery of capabilities. For time-sensitive or AFGSC/CC-directed efforts, this process will be expedited further. Requests requiring minimal clarification may proceed directly to execution following triage (see **Chapter 6**).

5.3.7. Iterative Governance and Phased Execution. Governance bodies (DMAB, DAI-WG, DGA-WG) shall not require exhaustive, end-state architectural or requirement documentation as a prerequisite for initial pilot or MVP support. Governance check-ins shall evaluate real-world user feedback and demonstrated capability from the MVP, allowing efforts to pivot, scale, or fail fast based on actual performance rather than theoretical planning.

5.4. Priority Tiers.

5.4.1. Purpose. Priority tiers provide a framework for sequencing and balancing DM&A execution capacity following rapid triage. Priority tiers inform workload sequencing, capacity protection, and enterprise awareness; they do not constitute approval authority and do not authorize execution.

5.4.2. Assignment of Priority Tiers. Priority tiers are assigned as part of the rapid triage process by the designated triage function led by AFGSC/A9. Tier assignment is informed by AFGSC/CC priorities, strategic alignment, urgency, and scope. Priority tier assignment may be refined as additional information becomes available through working-level collaboration or enterprise coordination.

5.4.3. DM&A efforts are categorized into the following priority tiers:

5.4.3.1. **Tier 0:** ***Commander Effort.*** Efforts directed by the AFGSC/CC. Tier 0 efforts receive protected execution capacity and are routed to AFGSC/CCZ, Commander's Resolution Office (CRO).

5.4.3.2. **Tier 1:** ***Command Priority.*** Efforts that directly support Command-level initiatives, urgent operational needs, or time-sensitive mission requirements. Tier 1 efforts are sequenced ahead of other demands and may require enterprise coordination or protected execution capacity.

5.4.3.3. **Tier 2:** ***Enterprise / Strategic Enablement.*** Efforts that support cross-functional integration, enterprise capabilities, strategic initiatives, or enduring analytic needs aligned

with Command priorities. Tier 2 efforts are sequenced to balance enterprise impact with available capacity.

5.4.3.4. **Tier 3: *Local / Functional Support.*** Efforts that primarily support directorate-, NAF-, or Wing-level decision-making with limited enterprise impact. Tier 3 efforts may be executed organically or aligned with enterprise efforts when beneficial.

5.4.3.5. **Tier 4: *Visibility Only - Locally Executed.*** Efforts that will be executed internally by the reporting agency.

5.4.3.6. **Tier 5: *Redirected or Not Executed.*** Requests determined to be out of scope, duplicative, infeasible, or better addressed through alternative means. Tier 5 designation does not preclude future reconsideration if conditions change.

5.4.4. Relationship to Working Groups and Execution. Priority tier assignment informs, but does not replace, working-level collaboration, enterprise coordination, or execution assignment.

5.4.4.1. Requests routed to working groups may retain their assigned priority tier while undergoing clarification or coordination.

5.4.4.2. Priority tiers inform capacity allocation and sequencing decisions described in **Chapter 6**.

5.4.4.3. Execution assignment decisions described in **Chapter 7** consider priority tier in combination with feasibility, scope, and available execution capacity.

5.4.5. Priority tiers may be adjusted based on refined scope, emerging dependencies, or AFGSC/CC direction.

5.5. Capacity Management.

5.5.1. Purpose. Capacity management is the process used to balance demand for enterprise-managed DM&A execution resources against available analytic and development capacity. Capacity management ensures AFGSC/CC priorities are supported while enabling enterprise and overflow support without overcommitting shared resources or degrading delivery quality.

5.5.2. Scope. Capacity management applies to enterprise-managed DM&A execution capacity, primarily analytic and database development resources managed by AFGSC/A9 that support cross-functional, enterprise, and overflow DM&A efforts. It does not apply to protected AFGSC/CC-facing execution capacity managed by the CRO or locally executed DM&A efforts conducted by HQ directorates, NAFs, or Wings within their delegated authorities.

5.5.3. Responsibilities.

5.5.3.1. AFGSC/CCZ. The CRO will manage protected execution capacity for AFGSC/CC-directed initiatives. CRO capacity is not governed by tier-based allocation but is monitored for awareness.

5.5.3.2. AFGSC/A9. AFGSC/A9 serves as OPR for enterprise DM&A capacity management. AFGSC/A9 will:

5.5.3.2.1. Maintain awareness of enterprise-managed workload and execution demand.

5.5.3.2.2. Apply priority tiers to inform sequencing and workload balancing.

5.5.3.2.3. Identify capacity constraints and delivery risk within the enterprise execution pool.

5.5.3.3. HQ Directorates, NAFs, and Wings. Directorates, NAFs, and Wings will manage capacity for locally executed DM&A efforts within delegated authorities. Local execution capacity is not governed by tier-based allocation but is monitored for awareness.

5.5.4. Enterprise Capacity Allocation Process.

5.5.4.1. Enterprise-managed execution capacity is balanced using priority tiers as a planning framework. As general planning guidance, AFGSC/A9-managed execution capacity will be distributed approximately as follows:

5.5.4.1.1. **Category 1: *Command Priority*** : ~30–35 percent

5.5.4.1.2. **Category 2: *Enterprise / Strategic Enablement*** : ~30–35 percent

5.5.4.1.3. **Category 3: *Local / Functional*** : ~15–20 percent

5.5.4.1.4. **Category 4: *Sustainment*** : ~10–15 percent

5.5.4.2. These percentages represent planning guardrails rather than fixed ceilings and reflect the proportion of active enterprise execution capacity applied at a given time.

5.5.5. Capacity Monitoring for Non-Enterprise Execution.

5.5.5.1. In addition to managing enterprise execution capacity, AFGSC maintains capacity awareness for non-enterprise DM&A execution to identify emerging risk, overload, or assistance requirements.

5.5.5.2. Capacity monitoring may include high-level indicators such as:

5.5.5.2.1. Number of active efforts.

5.5.5.2.2. General effort type (e.g., assessment, dashboard, tool).

5.5.5.2.3. Self-reported capacity strain or delivery risk.

5.5.5.3. Capacity monitoring supports awareness and coordination only and does not direct execution, reallocate resources, or alter delegated authorities.

5.5.6. Adjustment and Escalation.

5.5.6.1. When capacity constraints or execution risk is identified that may affect Command priorities or enterprise delivery, issues may be elevated to the DMAB for integration and, if required, to the DMAC for Commander decision.

5.5.6.2. Elevation is based on risk and impact, not workload volume.

5.5.6.3. Routine workload balancing and capacity awareness activities are expected to occur without escalation.

5.6. Workforce Capability and Training Gaps.

5.6.1. AFGSC recognizes that effective execution of DM&A initiatives requires deliberate development of workforce capability across analytic, digital, and emerging technology domains.

5.6.2. DMAG-related training and strategic workforce development are managed by AFGSC/CCZ.

5.6.3. AFGSC/CCZ will:

5.6.3.1. Identify and develop training aligned to emerging analytic methods, digital platforms, automation tools, artificial intelligence applications, and data governance requirements.

5.6.3.2. Integrate training requirements associated with data modernization, analytics maturity, and enterprise digital transformation initiatives.

5.6.3.3. Aggregate and assess recurring workforce capability gaps identified during intake, rapid triage, working group deliberations, execution reviews, and capacity management discussions.

5.6.3.4. Coordinate with governance bodies to ensure training requirements are aligned to Command priorities and data modernization initiatives.

5.6.4. Training requirements identified during governance processes will be routed to AFGSC/CCZ for evaluation, prioritization, and integration into the Command training portfolio.

5.6.5. Emerging technology adoption efforts will include a deliberate training and change management component prior to enterprise scaling.

Chapter 6

EXECUTION ASSIGNMENT AND DELIVERY

6.1. Execution Assignment.

6.1.1. Once a DM&A effort has completed intake, triage, and any required governance coordination, it is assigned to an execution arm best suited to deliver the required outcome. Execution assignment considerations include the following:

6.1.1.1. Type of effort (e.g., assessment, analytic study, dashboard, or tool development).

6.1.1.2. Intended decision audience (Commander-level, enterprise, or directorate-level).

6.1.1.3. Required analytic, technical, or domain expertise.

6.1.1.4. Available capacity across organic staff and contractor-supported teams.

6.1.1.5. Sensitivity, scope, and delivery timeline of the effort.

6.1.2. Execution assignment is coordinated to ensure alignment with governance outcomes, preservation of AFGSC/CC-directed capacity, and minimization of duplication across HQ AFGSC.

6.2. Boundaries.

6.2.1. Execution boundaries clarify responsibilities and prevent overlap among executing organizations.

6.2.2. As a general construct:

6.2.2.1. AFGSC/CC-specific efforts are executed through the Commander's execution arm.

6.2.2.2. Enterprise and cross-directorate efforts are executed through the designated enterprise execution arm.

6.2.2.3. Local efforts may be executed organically when enterprise integration is not required.

6.2.2.4. Contractor-executed efforts are executed in accordance with contract scope and government sponsor responsibilities.

6.3. Accountability.

6.3.1. Each DM&A effort will have a designated OPR accountable for coordination and alignment with its intended decision use. This OPR is known as the Project Sponsor. The Project Sponsor is normally the directorate or office that made the initial request for the DM&A effort or was designated by a member of the AFGSC Command Team. The Project Sponsor will remain accountable for defining decision intent and acceptance of final deliverables.

6.3.2. Each DM&A effort will also have an execution OPR. The execution OPR will:

6.3.2.1. Assign a primary point of contact (POC) for the development effort.

6.3.2.1.1. The execution OPR/POC will be the POC listed in the Coordination and Resolution Tracking Mechanism (CRTM).

6.3.2.1.2. A POC for the Project Sponsor will be identified in the plan description in the CRTM.

6.3.2.2. Regularly collaborate and coordinate with the Project Sponsor to ensure alignment of scope, schedule, and decision intent throughout the project lifecycle.

6.3.2.3. Coordinate activities across analysts, developers, contractors, and stakeholders as applicable.

6.3.2.4. Provide status updates through established governance and reporting mechanisms.

6.3.3. Clear execution accountability supports transparency, schedule discipline, and effective delivery while preserving flexibility in execution methods.

6.4. Execution Arms.

6.4.1. AFGSC executes DM&A efforts through defined execution arms to ensure accountability, protect limited capacity, and align delivery with AFGSC/CC intent. Execution arms represent default lanes for delivery based on decision level, scope, and required capability. Assignment to an execution arm does not modify governance authority, contracting authority, or funding responsibility.

6.4.2. Commander's Execution Arm.

6.4.2.1. The Commander's Execution Arm supports DM&A efforts directed by or primarily intended for the AFGSC/CC.

6.4.2.2. The CRO (AFGSC/CCZ) serves as the OPR for AFGSC/CC-specific DM&A efforts, as applicable:

6.4.2.2.1. Technical Development and Coding. For AFGSC/CC-specific dashboards, tools, or technical solutions requiring coding.

6.4.2.2.2. Qualitative Analyses and Assessments. For AFGSC/CC-directed qualitative analyses, assessments, or decision-support products not requiring technical development.

6.4.2.2.3. Training and Workforce Capability Efforts. For AFGSC/CC-directed efforts addressing identified training or workforce capability gaps related to DM&A.

6.4.2.2.4. Cross-Functional Teams (CFTs) and Integrated Process Teams (IPTs). For AFGSC/CC-directed efforts requiring CFTs or IPTs, the CRO oversees execution as the AFGSC/CC's representative to ensure alignment with AFGSC/CC priorities, intent, and decision timelines.

6.4.2.3. The Commander's Execution Arm is protected and will not be used as overflow capacity for enterprise or directorate-level efforts.

6.4.3. Enterprise Analytics and Development Execution Arm.

6.4.3.1. The Enterprise Analytics and Development Execution Arm supports DM&A efforts with enterprise-wide or cross-directorate impact.

6.4.3.2. AFGSC/A9 is the OPR for the Enterprise Analytics and Development Execution Arm and assigns tailored analytic and development teams based on project requirements. AFGSC/A9 serves as the default execution arm for the following:

6.4.3.2.1. Enterprise dashboards, tools, and analytic products.

6.4.3.2.2. Cross-functional analyses and assessments that are not AFGSC/CC-directed or directly assigned to the CRO.

6.4.3.2.3. Repeatable, scalable analytic solutions supporting multiple HQ AFGSC organizations.

6.4.3.3. This execution arm provides the primary enterprise delivery capability and supports integration, reuse, and sustainment of analytic and database dashboard products.

6.4.4. Local Organic Execution Arm.

6.4.4.1. Local Organic Execution Arms consist of analysts and practitioners embedded within HQ AFGSC directorates, NAFs, and Wings.

6.4.4.2. HQ AFGSC directorates, NAFs, and Wings may execute DM&A efforts organically when:

6.4.4.2.1. The effort supports functional or local decision-making.

6.4.4.2.2. Enterprise integration or cross-directorate coordination is not required.

6.4.4.2.3. Execution can be accomplished within existing local capacity.

6.4.4.3. All local-level organic DM&A efforts remain subject to portfolio visibility and registration requirements to mitigate duplication and support enterprise awareness.

6.4.4.4. When local-level DM&A efforts are being considered, organizations should engage with AFGSC/A9 to assess whether existing efforts may address the identified requirement or present opportunities for alignment.

6.4.5. Contractor-Executed Execution Arm.

6.4.5.1. Contractor-executed DM&A efforts provide surge capacity, specialized expertise, or long-duration development capability not available organically within AFGSC.

6.4.5.2. HQ AFGSC directorates, NAFs, and Wings may identify capability gaps and pursue contractor-executed DM&A efforts within their delegated authorities.

6.4.5.2.1. Contractor-executed efforts remain subject to governance visibility and coordination requirements and must still be registered through the standard intake mechanism for portfolio visibility and coordination. ***Note***: Portfolio visibility and coordination does not modify contracting officer authority, funding decisions, or execution responsibility.

6.4.5.2.2. When external assistance is being considered, organizations should engage with AFGSC/A9 to assess whether existing efforts may address the identified requirement or present opportunities for alignment.

6.5. Change Management and Post-Project Adoption.

6.5.1. Successful data modernization requires active organizational change management from the sponsoring organization to ensure delivered analyses, assessments, and tools are integrated into daily operations. It is the responsibility of the DMAB to establish operational adoption thresholds for the Command.

6.5.2. Following project completion, execution arms will track and report post-deployment adoption rates to the DMAB. When Command resources are expended to develop solutions, a failure to achieve operational adoption must be formally documented.

6.5.3. If a sponsoring organization cannot resolve internal adoption barriers, the DMAB will report the deficiency to the DMAC for leadership intervention, mitigation, and future resource prioritization.

6.6. Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Machine Learning (ML) Considerations.

6.6.1. AI-enabled capabilities will be implemented with appropriate human oversight, model validation, security compliance, and operational risk assessment consistent with DoW and DAF guidance to ensure responsible, mission-aligned use.

6.6.2. AI- and ML-enabled capabilities may be considered a subset of DM&A and follow the same intake, governance, prioritization, and execution processes described in this instruction. AI-enabled efforts do not require separate governance bodies or approval pathways.

6.6.3. When AI- or ML-enabled capabilities are proposed or developed, additional coordination will be applied based on risk, maturity, and operational impact:

6.6.3.1. The AFGSC/CDAO will ensure alignment with Command data and AI strategy, data readiness, and responsible adoption principles.

6.6.3.2. The AFGSC/CIO will ensure alignment with information technology, cybersecurity, and system authorization requirements.

6.6.3.3. Legal, ethics, or policy stakeholders will be engaged as appropriate based on scope and risk.

6.6.4. Additional coordination is applied selectively to ensure responsible, secure, and sustainable adoption without delaying execution.

6.6.5. Continuous Delivery and Feedback Loops. AI and ML capabilities are not static deliverables; they require continuous iteration. All AI/ML efforts governed by this instruction must incorporate automated mechanisms for continuous user feedback, data pipeline monitoring, and model retraining. Governance bodies will actively support the establishment of these continuous integration/continuous deployment (CI/CD) pipelines to ensure deployed models adapt rapidly to the shifting operational environment.

Chapter 7

ESCALATION AND DECISION FLOW

7.1. Escalation Principles.

7.1.1. AFGSC employs an exception-based escalation framework designed to resolve issues at the lowest appropriate level while ensuring enterprise visibility and AFGSC/CC decision when required. Escalation is driven by impact, not volume, and is used when coordination, sequencing, or working-level resolution cannot adequately address mission, enterprise, or Command-level implications. Escalation does not replace working-level accountability.

7.1.2. Routine execution matters, workload volume, or normal capacity saturation do not, by themselves, require escalation. Escalation is appropriate when unresolved issues create risk to mission execution, AFGSC/CC priorities, or enterprise outcomes.

7.2. Working Group Resolution.

7.2.1. Working group collaboration is the default mechanism for resolving DM&A issues. Routine coordination, scope refinement, feasibility assessment, sequencing adjustments, and integration discussions are expected to occur through working groups, execution coordination, and enterprise capacity management processes.

7.2.2. Issues should remain at the working level when they:

7.2.2.1. Can be resolved through analytic design, technical coordination, or sequencing.

7.2.2.2. Do not create enterprise-wide tradeoffs.

7.2.2.3. Do not affect Commander priorities or decision timelines.

7.2.2.4. Do not present sustained or systemic risk beyond the executing organization.

7.2.3. Effective working-level resolution preserves agility, reduces governance burden, and accelerates delivery.

7.3. DMAB Elevation.

7.3.1. Issues are elevated to the DMAB when enterprise-level integration, visibility, or coordination is required. The DMAB serves as the primary forum for surfacing, integrating, and framing issues prior to senior decision.

7.3.2. Issues appropriate for DMAB escalation include, but are not limited to:

7.3.2.1. Enterprise Capacity Constraints.

7.3.2.1.1. Sustained saturation of enterprise-managed execution capacity creates delivery risk or extended displacement of lower-tier work.

7.3.2.1.2. AFGSC/CC Priority initiatives persistently displace enterprise or overflow efforts beyond planned sequencing adjustments.

7.3.2.1.3. Capacity strain in AFGSC/CC-facing or locally executed efforts creates spillover risk affecting enterprise execution.

7.3.2.1.4. Capacity limitations cannot be mitigated through sequencing, scope adjustment, or coordination.

7.3.2.1.5. **Note:** Capacity overload alone does not require escalation. Escalation is appropriate when overload creates enterprise-level tradeoffs or risk.

7.3.2.2. Duplication, Conflict, or Integration Risk. Issues involving:

7.3.2.2.1. Actual or potential duplication of analytic or development efforts.

7.3.2.2.2. Conflicting scopes, timelines, or dependencies.

7.3.2.2.3. Overlap between organic and contractor-executed efforts.

7.3.2.2.4. Integration challenges affecting multiple organizations.

7.3.2.3. Cross-Organizational Impact. Issues that:

7.3.2.3.1. Affect multiple HQ directorates, NAFs, or Wings.

7.3.2.3.2. Require coordination across execution arms.

7.3.2.3.3. Have enterprise implications that exceed local resolution authority.

7.3.2.4. Enterprise Framing. Issues that require:

7.3.2.4.1. Development of integrated options.

7.3.2.4.2. Clarification of impacts, risks, or dependencies.

7.3.2.4.3. Preparation of decision-ready materials for potential elevation.

7.3.3. The DMAB integrates inputs, facilitates coordination, and prepares issues for senior decision when required.

7.4. DMAC Escalation.

7.4.1. The DMAC serves as the senior decision authority and addresses matters that exceed coordination authority. Issues are elevated to the DMAC only when AFGSC/CC decision or direction is required.

7.4.2. Issues appropriate for DMAC escalation include:

7.4.2.1. Tradeoffs between AFGSC/CC Priority initiatives.

7.4.2.2. Acceptance of enterprise or mission risk that affects AFGSC/CC intent.

7.4.2.3. Reprioritization with Command-wide implications.

7.4.2.4. Direction to surge, defer, or realign DM&A efforts beyond coordination authority.

7.4.2.5. Resolution of enterprise conflicts that cannot be addressed through integration or sequencing.

7.4.3. Capacity-related issues are elevated to the DMAC only when:

7.4.3.1. Enterprise or Command-level tradeoffs cannot be resolved through coordination or sequencing, and the impact affects mission outcomes, AFGSC/CC priorities, or decision timelines.

7.4.3.2. Strategic direction or reprioritization is necessary.

7.4.4. Routine execution, coordination, and feasibility matters are not elevated to the DMAC. The DMAC focuses on exception-based decision-making to preserve AFGSC/CC time and decision advantage.

STEPHEN L. DAVIS
General, USAF
Commander

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

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Prescribed Forms

None

Adopted Forms

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Product,*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AFGSC—Air Force Global Strike Command

AFI—Air Force Instruction

AFPD—Air Force Policy Directive

AFRC—Air Force Reserve Command

AI—Artificial Intelligence

ANG—Air National Guard

API—Application Programming Interface

CA—Chief Architect

CAO—Chief Analytics Officer

CC—Commander

CDAO—Chief Data and Artificial Intelligence Officer

CFT—Cross-Functional Team

CIO—Chief Information Officer

CoS—Chief of Staff

CRO—Commander's Resolution Office

CRTM—Coordination and Resolution Tracking Mechanism

CTO—Chief Technology Officer

DAF—Department of the Air Force

DAFI—Department of the Air Force Instruction

DAI-WG—Data Analytics and Integration Working Group

DGA-WG—Data Governance and Architecture Working Group

DM&A—Data Modernization and Analytics

DMAAD—Data Modernization, Analytics, Assessments, and Dashboards

DMAB—Data Modernization and Analytics Board

DMAC—Data Modernization and Analytics Council

DMAG—Data Modernization and Analytics Governance

DoD—Department of Defense

DoDI—Department of Defense Instruction

DoW—Department of War

FFRDC—Federally Funded Research and Development Center

HQ—Headquarters

IPT—Integrated Process Team

IT—Information Technology

ML—Machine Learning

MVP—Minimum Viable Product

NAF—Numbered Air Force

OPR—Office of Primary Responsibility

PHI—Protected Health Information

PII—Personally Identifiable Information

POC—Point of Contact

RBAC—Role-Based Access Controls

SME—Subject Matter Expert

UARC—University Affiliated Research Center

Office Symbol

AFGSC/A9—leads designated rapid-triage functions and supports enterprise-managed analytics capacity.

AFGSC/CCZ—Commander's Resolution Office (CRO).

AFGSC/CoS—Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) for the instruction.

Terms

Commander's Execution Arm—The execution arm supporting DM&A efforts directed by or primarily intended for the AFGSC Commander.

Contractor-Executed DM&A Effort—A DM&A activity managed and overseen solely by an AFGSC-contracted organization.

Cross-Organizational Impact—An effort that analyzes data across multiple directorates or subordinate units, drives change across multiple units, or exposes previously siloed data to the enterprise federated catalog.

Data Analytics (and AI/ML)—The use of enterprise data to produce actionable insight and decision advantage, ranging from descriptive reporting to autonomous machine decision-making.

Data Modernization—The transformation of legacy or siloed information environments into an interoperable, cloud-centric, artificial intelligence-ready data architecture that treats data as a strategic enterprise asset.

Data Modernization and Analytics (DM&A)—Activities that modernize data environments and apply data, analytics, artificial intelligence, and machine learning capabilities to produce decision advantage.

DM&A Portfolio—The collection of registered DM&A efforts maintained to support enterprise visibility, duplication mitigation, reuse identification, and coordination.

DMAAD Intake Form—The AFGSC Data Modernization, Analytics, Assessments, and Dashboards intake mechanism used to capture essential non-proprietary information for portfolio visibility, triage, and coordination.

Enterprise Capacity Management—The process of balancing demand for enterprise-managed analytic and development resources against available capacity while protecting Command priorities and delivery quality.

Enterprise DM&A Effort—A DM&A effort with cross-organizational impact, a persistent digital output on an enterprise-level platform, or new architecture and integration requirements.

Enterprise-Level Platform—A large-scale, authoritative data environment that ingests, integrates, and federates data from multiple databases or source systems to support cross-domain visibility, advanced analytics, artificial intelligence, and Command-wide decision advantage.

Execution Arm—A designated delivery lane for DM&A efforts based on decision level, scope, and required capability; assignment does not modify governance, contracting, or funding authority.

Execution OPR—The organization responsible for coordinating delivery of a DM&A effort, assigning a primary POC, and maintaining alignment with the Project Sponsor.

Hybrid DM&A Effort—A DM&A activity managed and overseen by AFGSC and executed with contractor support.

Local Organic Execution—DM&A work performed by analysts or practitioners within HQ AFGSC directorates, NAFs, or Wings when the effort supports local decision-making and does not require enterprise integration.

Operational Adoption—The integration of a delivered analysis, assessment, dashboard, tool, or other capability into routine operations by the sponsoring organization.

Portfolio Registration—The recording of limited non-proprietary information on a DM&A effort to support portfolio awareness; registration does not constitute approval, prioritization, funding, acquisition oversight, or execution tasking.

Post-Deployment Adoption Rate—The measured degree to which a delivered capability is being used in operations after fielding.

Priority Tiers—A framework used to inform sequencing, capacity planning, and enterprise awareness for DM&A efforts; tier assignment does not authorize execution.

Project Sponsor—The designated OPR accountable for defining the decision intent and accepting final deliverables for a DM&A effort.

Rapid Triage—A time-bound working-level evaluation of a DM&A request used to clarify intent, assess feasibility, and determine appropriate routing without delaying execution; it does not constitute approval, prioritization, or detailed analysis.

Tier 0—Commander Effort—A DM&A effort directed by the AFGSC Commander that receives protected execution capacity and is routed to the Commander's Resolution Office.

Tier 1—Command Priority—A DM&A effort that directly supports Command-level initiatives, urgent operational needs, or time-sensitive mission requirements.

Tier 2—Enterprise/Strategic Enablement—A DM&A effort supporting cross-functional integration, enterprise capabilities, strategic initiatives, or enduring analytic needs aligned with Command priorities.

Tier 3—Local/Functional Support—A DM&A effort primarily supporting directorate-, NAF-, or Wing-level decision-making with limited enterprise impact.

Tier 4—Visibility Only—Locally Executed—A DM&A effort executed internally by the reporting organization and registered for enterprise visibility.

Tier 5—Redirected or Not Executed—A request that is out of scope, duplicative, infeasible, or better addressed through another means.

Working Group Routing—The assignment of a request to the Data Analytics and Integration Working Group or Data Governance and Architecture Working Group when additional collaboration, clarification, or coordination is required before execution.